

Societal Challenge: Dutch Housing Crisis

Anonymous Group Submission

October 1, 2026

1 Group Section: The Societal Challenge

1.1 The News Article



Figure 1: Screenshot of the NL Times news article.

This news article was reported by ANP and published on 20-12-2025 in NL Times which is news channel focuses on Dutch news.

1.2 The Challenge

We have chosen this topic because of the attention it has gained in recent years and because of its broad impact on society. As students, we are also affected by this issue, particularly through the rental market. Rising house prices can contribute to higher rental prices, making affordable housing more difficult to find for students and young adults. The challenge is therefore especially relevant for young people who depend on rental housing or plan to buy their first home in the future. Other important stakeholders include first-time buyers, renters, homeowners, housing associations, banks, municipalities, and the Dutch government.

2 Scientific articles

2.1 Team Member 1

Scientific Article Citation:

Hochstenbach, C. (2024). Framing the housing crisis: politicization and depoliticization of the Dutch housing debate. *Housing Studies*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2024.2344844>

Article Subtype:

Original Research Article (Empirical Article)

Relevance to the Challenge:

The research paper examines the political aspect of the housing crisis and how it affects the dutch politics. Since middle class and young adults such as students are the main group of interest of housing crisis, politicians prepare their campaigns in order to influence their opinions.

2.2 Team Member 2

Scientific Article Citation:

Tarne, R., & Bezemer, D. (2025). *Roof or real estate? An agent-based model of housing affordability in the Netherlands*. *Structural Change and Economic Dynamics*, 72, 163–178. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.strueco.2024.11.014>

Article Subtype:

Original Research Article (Quantitative, Agent-Based Modeling)

Relevance to the Challenge:

This article is directly related to the societal challenge of housing affordability in the Netherlands because it investigates the causes of the Dutch housing affordability crisis. The authors analyze how the number of available homes, interest rates, and mortgage lending rules influence house prices and affordability. The study shows that financial factors also play an important role, meaning that increasing housing supply alone may not fully solve the affordability problem.

2.3 Team Member 3

Scientific Article Citation:

Fang, C., & van Liempt, I. (2021). ‘We prefer our Dutch’: International students’ housing experiences in the Netherlands. *Housing Studies*, 36(6), 822–842. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02673037.2020.1720618>

Article Subtype:

Original Research Article (Empirical Qualitative Study)

Relevance to the Challenge:

This article addresses the problem of housing crisis by examining its consequences on international students in the Netherlands. By analyzing the housing experiences of international students in Utrecht, such as landlord exploitation, temporary contract insta-

bilities, and systemic discrimination, the study reveals that the housing crisis in general affects these vulnerable minorities more severely than domestic residents.

2.4 Team Member 4

Scientific Article Citation:

Boelhouwer, P. (2019). *The housing market in The Netherlands as a driver for social inequalities: proposals for reform*. *International Journal of Housing Policy*, 20(3), 447–456. <https://doi.org/10.1080/19491247.2019.1663056>

Article Subtype:

Original Research Article (Qualitative Study)

Relevance to the Challenge:

Boelhouwer's (2019) policy review explains the root of the Dutch housing crisis. It shows how housing construction fell, while demand continued to grow, creating a persistent shortage, making the article relevant to the housing affordability challenge. It also argues that the Dutch policy favors established homeowners over new buyers, middle-income households being hit the hardest as they earn too much for social housing, but too little to meet the mortgage requirements.